

My psychological preferences and approach to stress vary greatly depending on my level of interest in the task I undertake. When I am working on schoolwork or projects that do not line with my interests, stress typically leads to inefficiency and mechanical execution rather than meaningful problem solution. In these circumstances, I prioritize completing the task over improving or optimizing it. Tight deadlines in such cases force me toward a "just get it done" approach, in which debugging, and optimization take a back seat to submission. While this ensures speedy completion, it frequently yields poor solutions and a lack of long-term involvement.

However, when I'm working on something I care about, such as a new company, an internship project, or research, my reaction to stress is vastly different. Instead of being overwhelmed, I focus on quality and optimization, ensuring that my solutions are both efficient and well-structured. Passion allows me to be self-critical even when under pressure, helping me to think clearly and fine-tune my approach rather than rushing to achieve a deadline.

Balancing UVA classroom, research at the business school, and an internship has reinforced this trend. Juggling several duties frequently results in overlapping deadlines, forcing me to alter my process. When given enough time, I prefer to work collaboratively, consulting mentors, iteratively revising my code, and ensuring a structured knowledge of reasoning prior to execution. However, when time is restricted, my attitude changes: schoolwork that does not engage me leads to hasty execution, whereas projects that I am passionate about motivate me to optimize and perfect even under tight deadlines.

When launching a new business this distinction is critical. When I am truly interested in my work, stress does not detract from my focus and devotion to quality. Under tight timelines, I try not only to complete tasks, but also to ensure that they are completed optimally. This ability to remain calm and self-critical under pressure is valuable in high-stakes situations where providing an efficient and well-thought-out answer is just as vital as fulfilling deadlines.